In any event, with more than enough petrol still swilling around in the tank, I flew home after the World Cup in March 2015, joined Royal Challengers Bangalore for another IPL tournament and eventually took my place in the Proteas squad, gathered to undertake a two-Test tour of Bangladesh in July 2015.

I opened with Quinton when we won the two T20 internationals in Mirpur and enjoyed the experience; but then – for the one and only time in my international career – I asked permission to leave the tour and miss the two Test matches, because I wanted to attend the birth of my son back home.

The timing was not ideal because the second Test in Bangladesh would have been not only my 100th Test match but also my 100th consecutive Test because I had not missed a single Test played by South Africa since my debut in December 2004. I could have been the first player to achieve this feat, but I've never chased records and, to be honest, there was no chance that I would miss the birth of my son.

Danielle and I decided our son would be named Abraham Benjamin de Villiers, after my father. The first recorded Abraham de Villiers in South Africa was the second of the three brothers who emigrated from La Rochelle, in France, via Holland, in 1689, and it meant a lot to me that, quite apart from continuing this long-standing tradition, my son would have the same names as my dad.

AB junior was born on the second day of the first Test in Chittagong, which was cut short by rain and drawn, and I was preoccupied with changing nappies and being helpful around the house by the time Bangladesh batted on the first day of the second Test, before persistent rain washed out the next four days.

In August, I rejoined the Proteas for a limited-overs series at home to New Zealand, billed as an opportunity for revenge after the World Cup semifinal. The original plan was that I would keep wicket in these matches, but Morné van Wyk took this responsibility, and I was free to